

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Penny Pincher

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Penny Pincher

Eccentric Private Collector

Penny is convinced that every museum object would look better in her hallway. Penny collects small paintings, strange decorative objects, and stories about who owned them before she did.

- Asks **Hugh Bidder** for auction previews and always disputes his estimates.
- Shows **Vincent Van Faux** photos of paintings and asks for a free valuation.
- Has compared auction finds with **Tess Tament**. Penny prefers a bargain **Tess** has overlooked.

ACTING TIPS

Eccentric, charming, nosy, unexpectedly shrewd. Ask questions that sound casual and are not.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Penny Pincher. Some things in this museum belonged to my family, so you'd think I'd at least get a discount on tickets. I'm delighted about all the free food tonight, though!

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Penny Pincher

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

One decorative object in the exhibition once belonged to your family. You believe Grant acquired it through a manipulative private sale decades ago.

Your other secret

You brought old correspondence proving your family contested that sale and planned to confront him tonight.

Conversations to start

- Ask Anya Tique whether she remembers the decorative object from your family.
- Ask Saul D. Bid how old private sales can be traced. If he is absent, try Hugh Bidder.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Look behind the rectangle that brings distant worlds into the living room.*
- 2 *A vase has swallowed a document. Rescue it without disturbing the china.*
- 3 *Seek the green lamp; its nearest neighbor is part of this investigation.*



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Penny Pincher

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The decorative object belonged to my family. Grant bought it through a private sale we contested in writing. I brought the letters to embarrass him in front of witnesses. He preferred a label thanking him for generosity. I have never enjoyed being told how grateful I ought to feel about somebody else displaying our possessions.

IF MURDERER

Grant called the object his generous gift. My family called the sale manipulative and kept the correspondence. I brought it tonight. He wanted to discuss the matter privately, where he could describe the letters as an old misunderstanding. I wanted him to read them with somebody else listening.



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Penny Pincher

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I went into the object-study room to compare the family monogram with the letter. Its security door stayed shut until the inspection ended. I came out and took the letter back to the gallery entrance. The match was clear. Grant's enthusiasm for private discussion had become rather less mysterious.

IF MURDERER

I compared the letter with the catalog photograph at the gallery table. I had looked at the object earlier and wanted to copy the monogram accurately. Grant had seen the correspondence in his salon before the glass arrived. Before the toast I was deciding which paragraph to ask him to explain publicly.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Penny Pincher

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The object-study room had three blue seals over its side panels. They stayed intact while I was inside from 6:39 to 6:45. The family monogram matched the letter. I also removed the sale receipt from Grant's archive folder. He already knew what it said; I wanted an original document when he described the sale to the room.

IF MURDERER

The catalog photograph shows the family monogram clearly enough to compare at a table. I removed the sale receipt from Grant's folder and kept it with our letter. He had retained the correspondence and still intended to tell the story without mentioning it. I wanted him to explain the price as well as the acquisition.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Penny Pincher

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Tear off this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took the receipt and intended to embarrass Grant with the family letters. The object-study room log and intact blue seals keep me inside during the contamination interval. I wanted the object returned and the disputed sale acknowledged. I did not poison the person whose explanation I had finally arranged to hear.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I used the catalog photograph, not the sealed object-study room. The linen around my letter carried the reference toxin to Grant's coupe. He had bought the object cheaply and our silence even more cheaply. I wanted restitution. I chose revenge and told myself that the two could be made to resemble each other.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.